

index and rank pages. The attribute shows a tool-tip kind of text when you hover the mouse over the image. This descriptive text can help you get listed in search engines that use this feature for indexing and ranking. Of course, this does not work across all search engines, but you could definitely give it a try.

```
<IMG SRC = "thinkdigit.jpg"
width= "20" height= "20" alt=
"Think digit logo">
```



Search secrets

When providing keywords, the 'alt' attribute of any image on your Web page is a good place for placing commonly misspelled versions of a keyword and associated plural phrases.

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Get linked

Most traffic to your site would be directed from links that people click at other Web sites. So you need to build your online network and get listed on other sites that could pro-

vide a link to your page. You can exchange links with other people by visiting www.123link.com or www.recipro-links.com. Link exchange involves something called reciprocal links. This means that you need to list a particular site in order to get yourself listed on that site. While choosing a link exchange site, choose one that pertains to your content.

Check your stats

Check your stats and other log details regularly so that you can watch which pages are visited the most and which aren't. This will help you figure out which are the popular sections of your site and you can start providing more of the relevant content to your visitors.

Five ways not to promote your site

■ Say no to spam: If you start mass mailing frequently, you can be sure that your site will soon be ignored.

■ Submit right: There aren't more than 30 to 40 effective search engines. So don't waste money on sites that offer to get you listed in 500 search engines. Use some auto-submitters as we mentioned earlier and then make manual submissions to directories that hook with your interest and are relevant to the con-



Get listed

■ Focus on the site: Search engines rank their results according to relevance with the search phrase. If you get yourself listed on the 'Education' section while your page talks about entertainment, most visitors will turn away from your site. So focus on the content and get listed in the appropriate section.

■ Do not spam your index: If you think repeating the keyword in the Meta tags or the title of Web page will rank you higher in the search, you

are wrong. Most search engines are trained to ignore such spamming of keywords and they might even remove you from the result set.

■ Submit to specialised searches: Use the services of www.submitexpress.com or www.submit-it.com to submit your site to some of the popular search engines. Not all search engines work in the same manner. Look for special instructions on the search engine's Web site and customise accordingly.

tent of your Web page.

■ Perfection gentlemen: Do not host an incomplete site. If there are dead links or 'under construction' pages, visitors may not return. Complete the site in all respects and then upload it.

■ Play it safe: There are a lot of sneaky tricks available on the Internet that claim to increase your Web traffic. Do not fall for any of those. Use normal Meta tags and description tags as suggested earlier in this section.

■ Don't stop if you are finished: Site promotion is an on-going process and is never to be stopped. Once URL submissions are made to search engines, make sure that they are working. Check again after a month or as frequently as possible and

resubmit URLs if required. Check on services such as link exchanges and banner ads. Keep updating your pages regularly with newer content and that will keep your site alive and the visitors coming in.

Cool links

Submit your URLs
www.submit-it.com
www.submitexpress.com
www.siteowner.com/sifree.cfm
www.selfpromotion.com

Link exchange
www.geocities.com/CollegePark/Quad/6680/linkpage.htm
www.123link.com
www.reciprolinks.com
www.countrycalendar.com/our_links/

Time required to get listed on popular search engines

Search engine	Time
MSN	Up to two months
Google	Up to four weeks
AltaVista	Up to one week
Excite	Up to six weeks
AOL	Up to two months
HotBot	Up to two months
iWon	Up to two months



ISP Ratings, Interactive ISP finder, ISP Speed Test
Interactive ISP Comparison

ISP Finder

www.zdnetindia.com/isp